Nonetheless, despite these initiatives, India's policy towards China remains unaltered in its fundamentals. India will neither bandwagon with China, nor will it participate in a formal balancing coalition against China.

Power and interdependence in the Indo-Pacific

A potential challenge and weakness within the vast Indo-Pacific region is that it contains a number of subregions, shaped by discrete geographic formations, whose historical evolutions have resulted in political, economic, social, and cultural identities that complicate interactions between two or more subregions. The diversity of Asia's culture and polity, its civilisational heterogeneity, the shifting and divided allegiances that could be complicated by prejudice and misjudgement, the uneven growth across its nations and subregions, the disproportionate sizes of its economies, and the asymmetry in comprehensive national power among its states all are said to militate against cooperative behaviour. According to Samuel Huntington:

> Asia is the cauldron of civilizations. East Asia alone contains societies belonging to six civilizations – Japanese, Sinic, Orthodox, Buddhist, Muslim and Western – and South Asia add Hinduism. The core states of four civilizations, Japan, China, Russia and the United States, are major actors in East Asia; South Asia adds India; and Indonesia is a rising Muslim power. In addition, East Asia contains several middle-level powers with increasing economic clout, such as South Korea, Taiwan and Malaysia, plus a potentially strong Vietnam. The result is a highly complex pattern of international relationships,